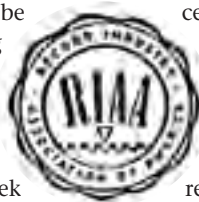


Decline in file sharing after RIAA threatens to sue individuals

The music industry, which has been perpetually frustrated by the continued popularity of peer-to-peer file sharing utilities, finally seems to have hit upon a tactic that works. At the end of June the RIAA declared that it would track individual users of these file sharing tools and sue each of them individually for sharing their files. The compensa-

tion claimed would be \$1,50,000 per song traded. At that rate many users would soon be picking up a tab of a few million dollars. In just a week after the announcement, traffic on these networks has dipped noticeably. Nielsen-NetRatings reports that usage on Kazaa went down by 15 per



cent. Other popular networks have also experienced similar declines, with Morpheus and iMesh losing 15 per cent and 16 per cent respectively. Another possible explanation is Apple's iTunes music store. The service has already sold over 5 million songs in the two months that it has been operational.

Hacking contest

When www.defacers-challenge.com announced a contest for hackers on the sixth of July, everyone in the online business was worried. According to the Web site, the first hacker to deface 6,000 sites; or the highest number of sites; would win a prize of 500 MB of Web space.

Concerns about the crip-

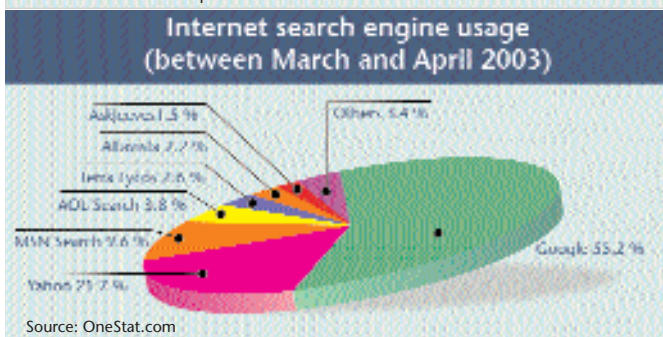
pling of countless Web sites were unfounded, as the event was drawing to a close there was no sign of damage among the Web's most popular sites such as Amazon.com and Yahoo.com.

This contest caused various reactions across the industry. Security officials said that this contest received so much press attention, that

it would only encourage more elaborate events in the future. But, only 500 to 600 smaller Web sites recorded defacements, which is less than the 3,000 or so sites that are defaced on a heavy hacking day.

Others were of the opinion that it was good thing, as it made people more aware about their security.

statattack



Sony handheld engine

Sony recently released its Handheld processor dubbed 'The Handheld Engine'. The Sony CLI PEG-UX50 will be the first handheld to use the chip.

The handheld engine is optimised for handheld devices, with special emphasis placed on battery life and speed. It combines a Sony manufactured ARM926-based processor, a Digital Signal Processor and a CXD2230GA graphics accelerator. This is the first time an in house processor is being used in the Sony Handheld.



redalert

Virus through Spam

A new tool to spread spam is slowly emerging. Junk e-mailers are sending viruses which spread spam anonymously. The research done by Message Labs, an e-mail security firm says that mass distributions of junk e-mail are increasingly coming from the Internet addresses of computers that have in the past sent out viruses as e-mail attachments. This could very well become the largest source of viruses. Also, finding the source of such a virus would be difficult. Such an infection blends the evils of a computer virus—spam and spyware. Also, it would be very easy to create variants of such infections. The only practical solution to this is to ensure that e-mail and attachments are checked before downloading.

W32.HLLW.Indor.E@mm

W32.HLLW.Indor.E@mm is a mass-mailing worm that is now a high threat level. It spreads across computers using Microsoft Outlook. It sends a zipped copy of itself to all the contacts in the Microsoft Outlook Address Book—with files such as SaveNow.zip and Report.zip. When the virus runs, it displays a fake message that states "Error in file #1: bad Zip file offset (Error local header signature not found): disk #1 offset: 68669733. The virus may also spread through network drives, floppy disks, the KaZaA file-sharing network, and mIRC. Visit <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/download/pages/US-N95.html> for a removal.

